

Catch Blue

A short tutorial for first-time players

What is Catch Blue?

Catch Blue is a study game. Blue has escaped onto a grid of Anatomy & Physiology topics, and your job is to catch up. Every square on the board is a topic. To step onto a square, you answer one question from that topic. Get it right and you move. Get it wrong and Blue runs one square farther away. Reach Blue, answer one more question, and you win.

Playing in your browser: open https://davhardin.github.io/catch_blue. The game takes a moment to load the first time. If the screen sits still after loading, click once inside the game area to start it.

The menus

1. Select Game

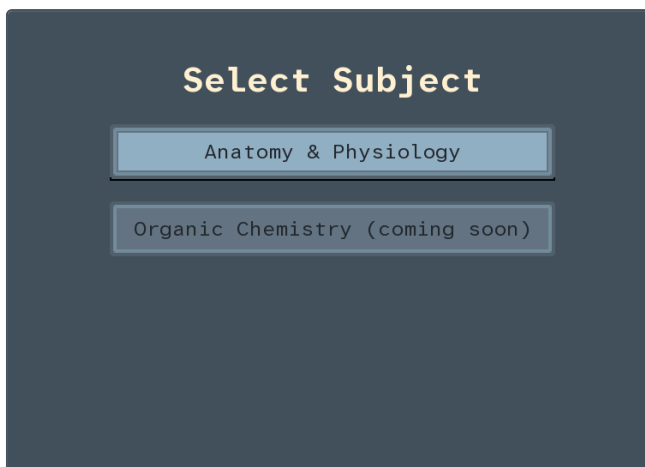
The first screen offers the game modes. Click **Catch Blue** to begin. **Run from Red** is a future mode and is greyed out for now. **Settings** opens the difficulty options, described at the end of this guide.

2. Select Subject

Choose **Anatomy & Physiology**. Organic Chemistry is on the way but is not playable yet. Every menu after the first has a **Back** button in its lower-left corner that returns to the previous screen.



Select Game: the starting screen.



Select Subject: pick Anatomy & Physiology.

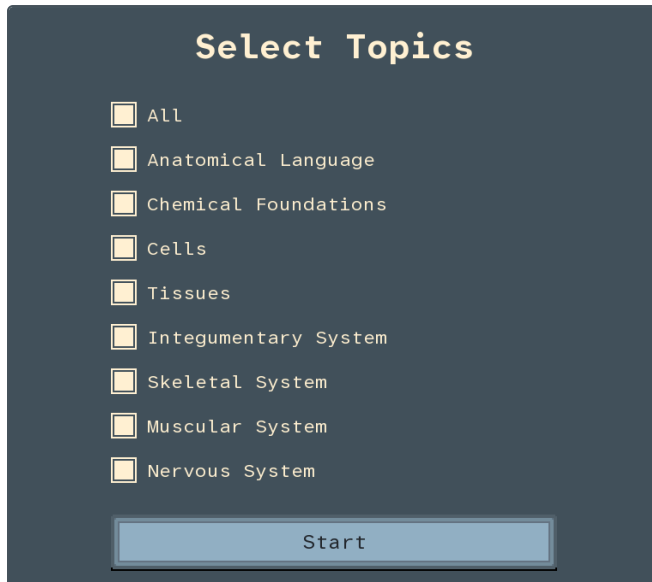
3. Select Topics

This screen decides which questions you will see. Each row is a chapter-sized topic, listed in course order. Everything is ticked when you first arrive, so clicking **Start** right away gives you questions from the whole subject.

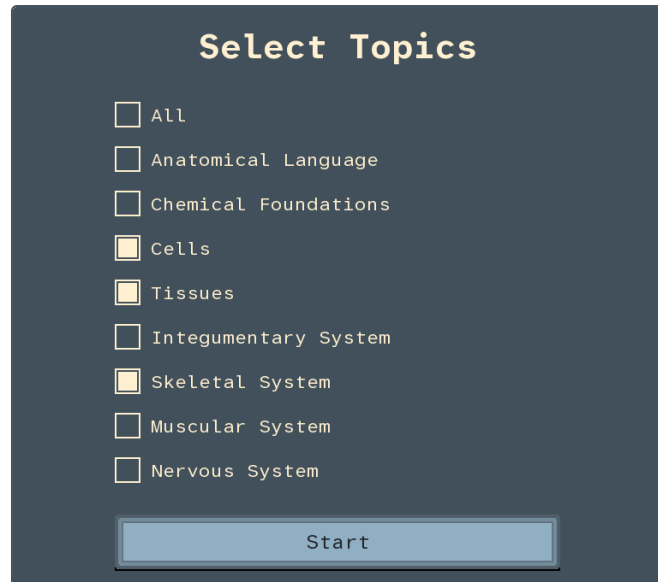
To study a few topics instead:

1. Click **All** once to clear every box.
2. Click the topics you want. Clicking a ticked box unticks it again.
3. Scroll with the mouse wheel to reach topics lower in the list.
4. Click **Start**. It stays greyed out until at least one topic is ticked.

Your selection is remembered while the game is open, so **Back** and returning later shows the same ticks.



Fresh Topics screen: every topic ticked.



After clearing All and ticking Cells, Tissues, and Skeletal System.

Playing the game

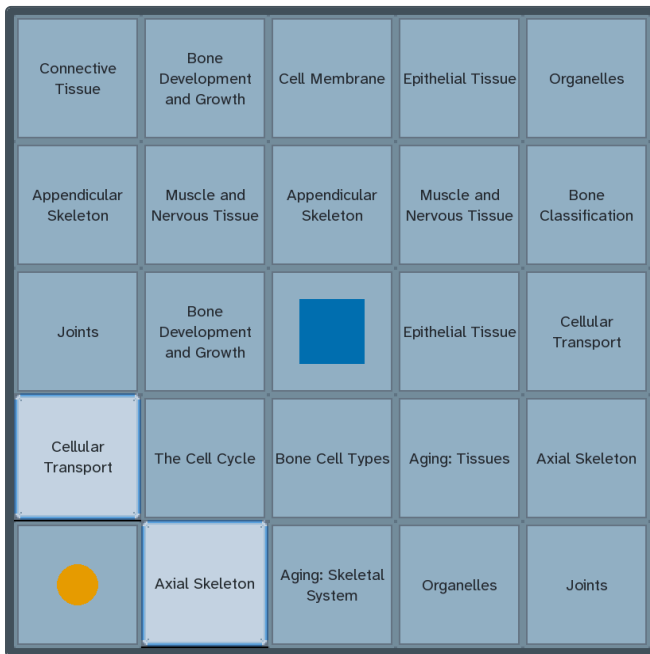
The board

The board is a grid of topic squares. On the default settings it is five by five. You are the **orange circle**, starting in the bottom-left corner. Blue is the **blue square** in the centre. The label on each square is the subtopic its question will come from, so you can see what you are about to be asked before you commit to a move.

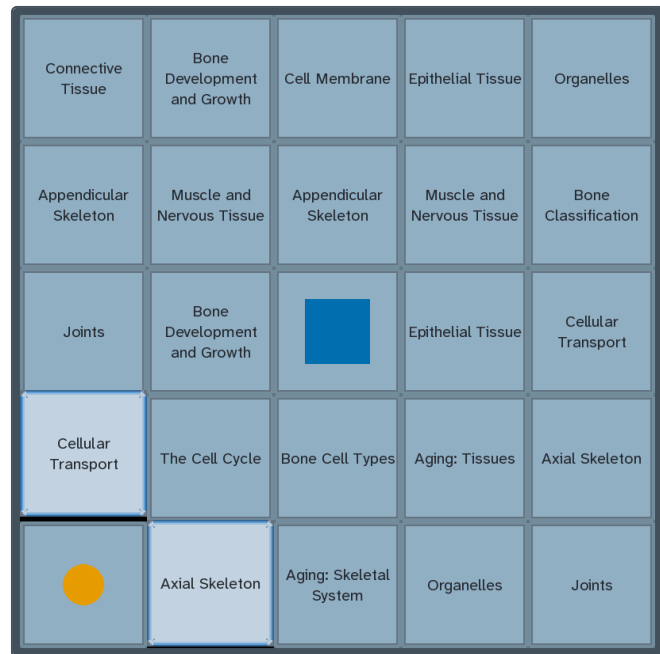
The counter in the top right shows your **moves remaining**. Every question you answer costs one move, whether you get it right or not.

Moving

You can move to the squares directly above, below, left, or right of you. Diagonal moves are not allowed. Squares you can move to are a lighter shade and lift slightly when you point at them. Click one to be asked its question.



The starting board. Each square names the subtopic its question comes from.

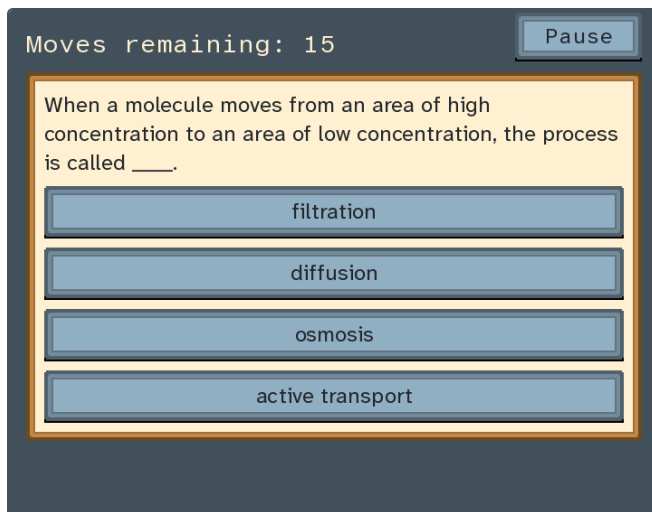


Pointing at the square above the player. The two lighter squares are the legal moves from the corner.

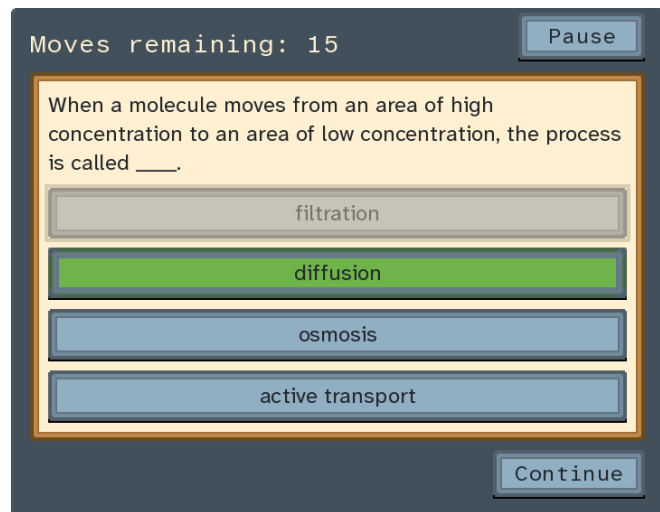
Answering a question

The question appears in the panel on the right with four choices. Click the answer you think is correct.

- **Correct:** your answer glows green for about a second, then you move onto the square.
- **Wrong:** your choice is greyed out and the correct answer is shown in green. The panel stays open as long as you like so you can read the right answer. Click **Continue** when you are ready. Blue then runs one square away from you.



A question. Click one of the four choices.

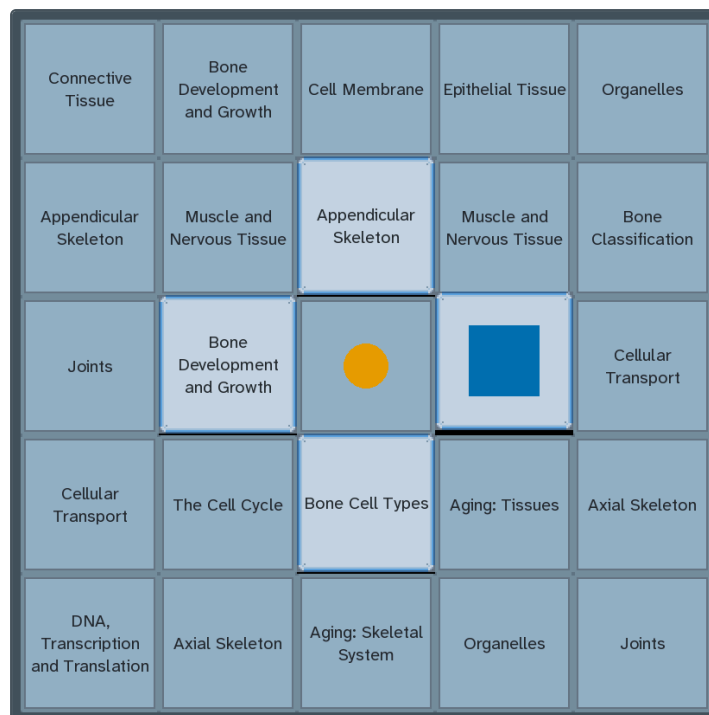


A wrong answer: the chosen answer is greyed, the correct one is green, and Continue waits for you.

Questions do not repeat within a topic until that topic's pool has been used up, so replaying the same topics keeps giving you new material.

Catching Blue

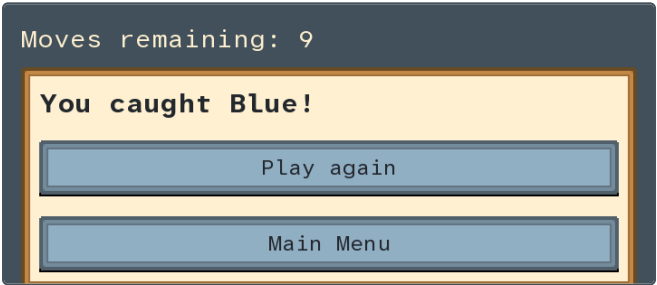
Blue's square is never a normal move. When you are standing directly next to Blue, Blue's square lights up to show it can be caught. Click it, answer the question correctly, and the game ends with a win. Answer wrong, and Blue runs again.



Next to Blue. Blue's square is lit and lifted: click it to attempt the catch.

Winning and losing

You win when you catch Blue. You lose when you run out of moves, or as soon as Blue is farther away than the moves you have left, since a catch is no longer possible. The end screen offers **Play again** (a fresh board with the same topics and settings) or **Main Menu**.



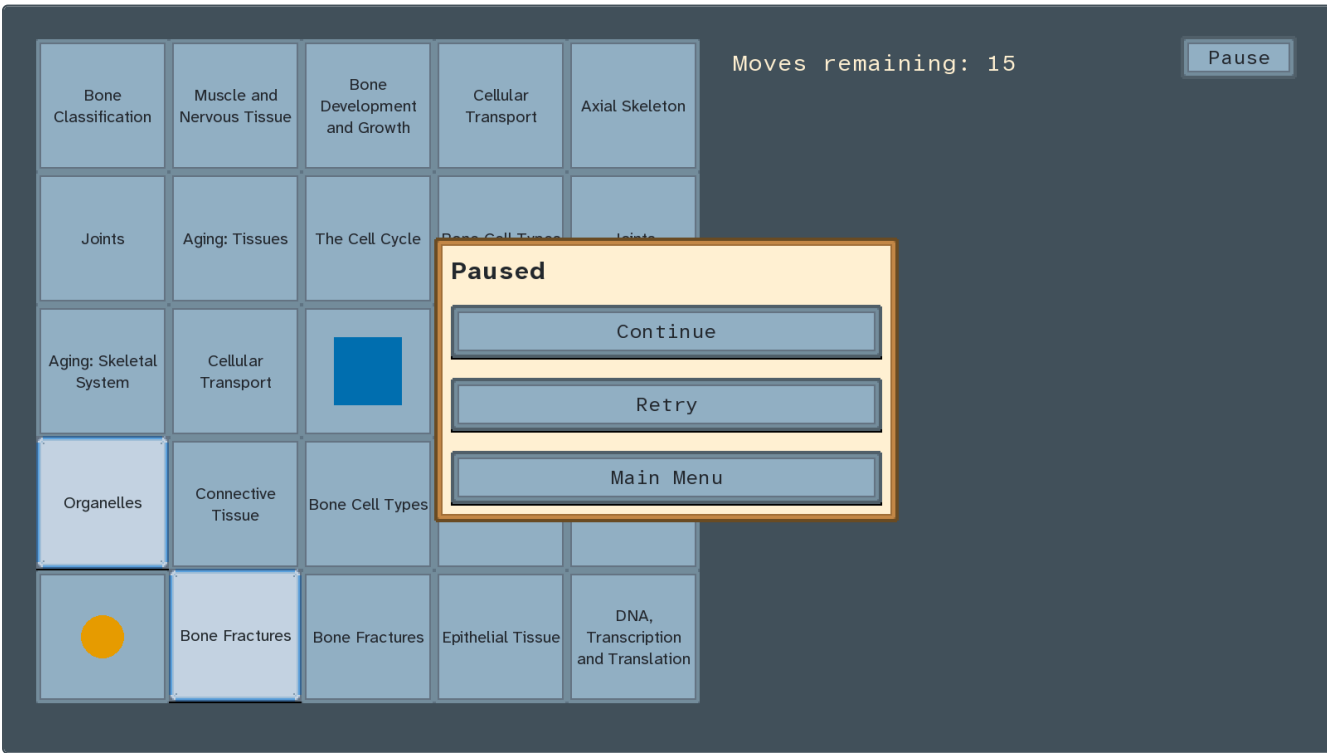
You caught Blue!



Blue got away. Try again or return to the menu.

Pausing

Click **Pause** in the top right, or press the **Esc** key. The game freezes completely, including a question you are in the middle of. **Continue** picks up where you left off, **Retry** starts a new board with the same topics, and **Main Menu** returns to the first screen.



The pause menu over a frozen board.

Tips

- Read the labels before you move. If you have a choice of routes, go through the topics you know best.

- Blue runs away from you, so it tends to end up in a corner. Head toward it directly and it runs out of room.
- A wrong answer costs you two squares of ground: the move you spent, and the square Blue gains. Slow down and read every choice.
- The board is reshuffled every game, so Play again is a new puzzle with the same topics.

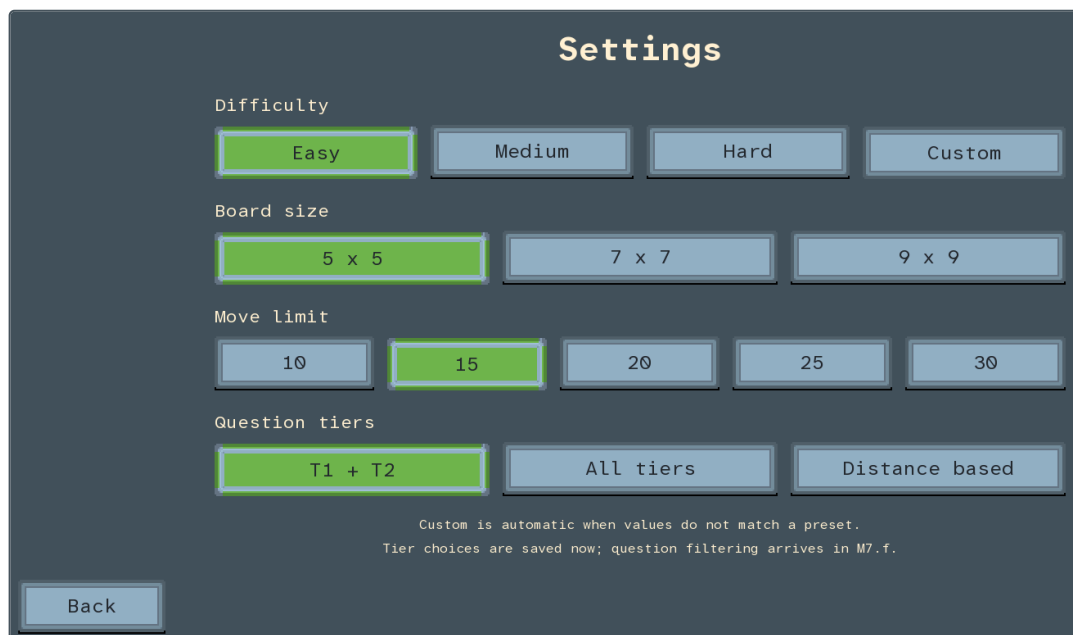
Settings, briefly

Settings is reached from the Select Game screen. The **Difficulty** row sets everything at once:

Preset	Board	Moves
Easy (default)	5 x 5	15
Medium	7 x 7	20
Hard	9 x 9	25

Below it you can change the **Board size** and **Move limit** on their own. As soon as a value differs from a preset, Difficulty reads **Custom**. A bigger board means Blue starts farther away, so give yourself more moves if you enlarge it. The **Question tiers** row is still being finished and does not change which questions you see yet.

Settings last until you close the game and reset to Easy the next time you open it. Click **Back** to return to the menu; your choices are kept.



The Settings screen on the Easy preset. UI assets: Kenney. Fonts: Braille Institute (Atkinson Hyperlegible).